

Decoupled Docs Export API

Shared externally with partners

A new Drive API, /exportGDoc, will be available to export Google Editor (Docs, Slides, Sheets) files to decoupled docs format (.gdoc, .gslides, .gsheet).

The API exports the latest version of the document. If the file is modified while export was in progress, export obeys the head version of the file at the time of request. Note that the files could be added/modified/removed in Drive while the export was in progress, and the partner would need to ensure the appropriate export behavior using existing Drive APIs.

Export is not allowed for files where download/copy/print action is [explicitly disabled](#) for the given file. Export for suspended user's file is not allowed either. This behavior is aligned with the existing Drive Export API. We recommend only exporting files **owned by** the user that you're calling on behalf of.

Request

HTTP request

GET [https://www.googleapis.com/drive/v2beta/files/**fileId**/exportGDoc](https://www.googleapis.com/drive/v2beta/files/fileId/exportGDoc)

Note: case sensitive

Parameters

Parameter name	Value	Description
Path parameters		
fileId	string	The ID of the file.
Required query parameters		
mimeType	string	The MIME type of the format requested for this export. For a complete list of all decoupled docs MIME types supported for each G Suite document, refer to the supported mimetypes section below.

G Suite documents and corresponding decoupled docs export MIME types

- Google Docs: application/vnd.google-apps.document.internal
- Google Slides: application/vnd.google-apps.presentation.internal
- Google Sheets: application/vnd.google-apps.spreadsheet.internal

Response

API returns exported file contents in the response body. In case of error, a [standard HTTP error code](#) with descriptive messages will be returned. E.g. 400 for mime type not supported, 400 for file too large, 403 for rate limit exceeded, etc. Exports can fail due to internal errors. In case of retryable errors (e.g. 500 backend error), retry may fix the issue, if not, refer to the fallback mechanisms below for the rest of errors.

Failure fallbacks

When a file export returns a permanent error, the user can get their desired export as OOXML manually by:

1. Opening file on Google Editor, and [downloading](#) into one of the formats listed.
2. Using the [takeout](#) interface into one of the formats listed.

These are the same mitigations that we recommend today when using the standard Drive Export API.

Authorization

The API requires [OAuth based authentication](#). For more information, see the [authentication and authorization](#) page. For admins, the API can be used with [domain-wide delegation of authority to admin](#) with the help of service accounts.

The API is restricted to only whitelisted clients and each client needs to provide a Google cloud [project id](#) for whitelisting.

This request allows authorization with at least one of the following scopes:

Scopes

<https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive>
<https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.file>
<https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.readonly>

Quota

Requests to this API would be throttled at 1,000 queries per 100 sec (~10 qps). This restriction applies on top of the default Google Drive API quota for a project (managed on Google Developer console). The Google Drive API's default quota is:

Queries per day: 1,000,000,000

Queries per 100 seconds per user: 1,000 (~10 pqs)

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Queries per 100 seconds: 10,000 (~100 qps)

There may be other quotas enforced to prevent abuse and outage. Partners can request additional quota via the Google Developer Console if required.

SLO

Export size >200MB would raise errors:

Source	Approx Expected Output File Too Large Errors (>200MB)
Google Docs	0.5%
Google Slides	1.5%
Google Sheets	0.5%

For files less than 200MB export size, below are expected export API success rates.

Source	Success rate (excluding large export requests)
Google Docs	99%
Google Slides	98%
Google Sheets	99%

These error rates are consistent with or an improvement over Drive's standard export APIs for Google Docs, Sheets, and Slides. Most export latencies would be under 100s, and similar to existing export latencies. *Note that the export latencies of Google Slides, in some cases, may be higher than 100s.*

Unsupported features

Decoupled Google Docs, Sheets and Slides don't support all the features that are supported on Google Drive. For the files exported using this migration API, these features will be removed with a graceful degradation to maintain data as appropriate. The behavior after migration is best effort to leave the data intact without supporting the feature. Google will publish these unsupported features in a new help center article. The ETA for the help center update is next month.